

Tejas Rao | Aspiring Researcher

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Education

Krea University, B.Sc in Biological Sciences and Data Science Apr 2023 – May 2027

- **Grade:** Rising 4th Year | GPA: **9.76/10** (On Dean's List since Freshman year)
- **Thesis** (till April, 2027): Deep Learning for Macaque MRI Segmentation | Under Researchers from **Harvard Medical School** and **Massachusetts General Hospital**
- **Coursework:** *Data Science:* Applied Statistics, Python for Data Science, Introduction to Statistical Learning, Deep Learning, Responsible AI, Geometry for Computer Vision, Introduction to Computer Vision, Applied Dynamical Systems, Data Analytics, Data Structures and Algorithms, Linear Algebra, Introduction to Calculus, Discrete Mathematics
Biological Sciences: Biostatistics (R), Biochemistry, Microbial Genomics, Genetics & Advanced Cell Biology Lab, Anatomy & Physiology, Physics for Chemists and Biologists, Evolution, Ecology & Conservation Biology, Life at Different Scales, Scientific Writing and Communication
Other: Scientific Reasoning, Written And Oral Communication (Academic Writing), Design Thinking, Ethics, Engaging with the Environment, Philosophical Perspectives

Digital SAT: Score of **1500/1600** (98th Percentile) May 2023

- Mathematics Section: **800/800** (99th Percentile) | Reading Section: **700/800** (93rd Percentile)

Grade 12 (CBSE - Sciences), NPS Agara: Grade of **96.87%** (99th Percentile) May 2023

Publications

Interpretable Deep Learning Predicts Polycythemia Vera and Identifies Novel Genomic Associations Dec 2025

Tejas Rao[†], Chepsy C. Philip, Bani Jolly, Aakash Chozakade, Minu Luckose, Bobby George, Sudhir Venkatesh, Bonnie George, Anupa Jacob, Vinod Scaria | Abstract in *Blood*, Poster presented at *ASH's 67th Annual Meeting* (†: Presenting Author)

Investigating Health Literacy and Sociodemographic Factors in College Students Jul 2025

Shyam Kumar Sudhakar, Divij Doshi, Gayatri Nair, **Tejas Rao** | *Scientific Reports (Nature Portfolio)*

Depolarization Block Susceptibility of Inhibitory Fast-Spiking Neurons: Biophysical Mechanisms that can Contribute to Seizure Initiation and Propagation

Shyam Kumar Sudhakar, **Tejas Rao**, Omar J Ahmed | *Final stages of Preparation, to be submitted to Epilepsia (IF: 6.6)*

From N- to O-Glycoproteomics: Revisiting Astral Narrow-Window DIA for O-Glycopeptide Discovery

Tejas Rao^{*}, Kathirvel Alagesan^{*} | *In Preparation (*: Equal Contribution)*

Contrast Agnostic Macaque MRI Segmentation

Tejas Rao^{*}, Ricardo Gonzalez^{*}, Anastasia Yendiki | *In Preparation (*: Equal Contribution)*

Experience

LINC Fellow, Harvard + MGH Nov 2025 – Present

- Selected as an undergraduate fellow embedded within the computational team at the Centre for Large-Scale Imaging of Neural Circuits (PI: Dr. Anastasia Yendiki), an NIH BRAIN CONNECTS project spanning Harvard, MIT, and MGH.
- Conducting Bachelor's Thesis under Dr. Ricardo Gonzalez on using domain randomisation and deep learning in MRI segmentation tasks to improve robustness and generalisation.
- Working with large-scale neuroimaging datasets and HPC workflows to prototype, train, and evaluate deep learning pipelines in Python/PyTorch.

Research Collaborator, Max Planck Unit for the Science of Pathogens – Remote Apr 2025 – Present

- Collaborating with the Proteomics Research Platform (incubated in Charpentier Lab, Nobel – 2020) under Dr. Kathirvel Alagesan on quantitative bottom-up mass spectrometry for O-glycoproteomics.

- Analysing large-scale DIA datasets to evaluate methods for profiling the O-glycoproteome; responsibilities include data cleaning, visualisation, and interpretation of glycopeptide-level trends.
- Contributing to manuscript writing, experiment design, project scope definition and figure generation.

Teaching Assistant, Krea University

Jan 2026 – Apr 2026

- Teaching Assistant for “Biostatistics” (BIOS227 | ENVS227 | PSYC227) under Dr. Guha Dharmarajan, supporting a cohort of 50+ undergraduate students.
- Conducted tutorials, practical classes and office hours clarifying core statistical concepts including hypothesis testing, regression, and data visualization.
- Delivered a lecture on statistical tests prevalent in biological research, effectively communicating key concepts to a large classroom setting.
- Provided hands-on guidance in R, addressing student queries with data cleaning, exploratory analysis, and reproducible workflows.
- Evaluated assignment submissions, offering structured and actionable feedback to improve reasoning coding practices. Assisted with course administration, including grading coordination, record maintenance, and student communication.

Bioinformatics Intern, Karkinos Healthcare

Jun 2025 – Sept 2025

- Supervised by Dr. Bani Jolly and Dr. Vinod Scaria in the Bioinformatics R&D Division of a precision oncology company.
- Developed a novel, explainable deep learning methodology to predict the presence of polygenic malignancies (e.g., Polycythemia Vera) with high fidelity, providing gene-level importance scores that recover known and highlight putative novel genomic associations. Pipeline used for further internal research, including an extension to a larger cohort.
- Implemented reproducible Python-based pipelines (HPC job scheduling, VCF handling, data preprocessing, model training) and contributed to results that were accepted to ASH 2025's annual meeting.
- Collaborated with AI/ML and Bioinformatics teams to characterise differences in Whole Exome Sequencing (WES) data between healthy individuals and cancer patients, with a focus on polygenic malignancies.

Work-Study Student, Krea University

Jan 2025 – Apr 2025

- Co-authoring a manuscript with Prof. Shyam Sudhakar & Prof. Omar Ahmed (UMichigan Ann-Arbor) on biophysical mechanisms underlying depolarisation block in fast-spiking (FS) neurons and their role in epileptic cell states.
- Performed data analysis and visualisation on simulations from biophysically accurate in-silico neuron models, focusing on parameter sensitivity and network-level behaviour.
- Conducted exploratory analysis and hypothesis testing on a pilot study exploring biological, neurological and sociodemographic determinants of mental health in collaboration with LEAD at Krea University.

Teaching Assistant, Krea University

Jan 2025 – May 2025

- Teaching Assistant for “Python for Data Science” (DATA201) for a cohort of 110+ students.
- Conducted tutorials and problem-solving sessions, clarified concepts in Python, data wrangling and introductory machine learning, and supported students with debugging and project development.
- Helped design assignments and assessments, graded submissions, and maintained consistent, constructive feedback to support student learning outcomes.

Research Intern and Trainee, Indian Institute of Technology, Delhi

Apr 2024 – May 2025

- Conducted a detailed literature review on Deep Learning and Quantum ML in Drug Discovery, synthesising insights from 120+ publications into structured notes and summaries.
- Independently explored Quantum ML models (QGAns & VQE) for small-molecule generation, focusing on how training strategies affect mode collapse and chemical diversity.
- Completed a one-month certification on Quantum Computing & ML (IIT-D: QCML), gaining foundational understanding of quantum circuits, variational algorithms and their applications.

Projects

Differential Effect of Gap Junctions on Depolarisation Block

Jan 2025 – May 2025

- Investigated how gap junction coupling can both promote and prevent the propagation of depolarisation block, an epileptic cell state, in networks of neurons.
- Collaborated with Prof. Shyam Sudhakar to design in-silico experiments probing network-specific parameters using biophysically realistic neuron models.
- Implemented and analysed simulation batches on HPC resources, extracting metrics that motivate future experimental and grant-funded work (anticipated continuation in October 2025).

Conversational RAG Chatbot for University Syllabus Queries

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

- Led requirements gathering (functional and non-functional) to scope a chatbot that answers curriculum-related queries for university students.
- Co-designed and implemented a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) chatbot in Python, integrating vector search over syllabus documents with an LLM-based conversational layer to provide contextual answers.
- Collaborated with a team of 3 students to containerise and deploy the system on AWS-EC2, performing basic load- and stress-testing to ensure scalability and stability before rollout.

Skillset

Technical Skills:

- *Programming and Data Analysis*: Python (Numpy, Pandas, Scipy, Matplotlib, Seaborn), R (Tidyverse, ggplot); Experience in performing statistical analysis and hypothesis testing across various projects and research contexts.
- *AI/ML & LLMs*: Machine Learning models (Sklearn), Deep Learning models (PyTorch), Explainable AI techniques, LangChain & LangGraph, RAG pipeline development, model evaluation and optimisation.
- *Bioinformatics & Computational Biology*: Genome analysis (VCF handling, sequence alignment, phylogenetics), NEURON (hoc), RDKit, AlphaFold, proteomics workflows including O-glycopeptide analysis.
- *Computing* HPC CLI, Shell scripting, cluster job scheduling (PBS and SLURM), containerisation (Docker), version control (Git), AWS (EC2)
- *Wet Lab*: Microbial culture, Drosophila handling & genetics, qPCR, SDS-PAGE, buffer & reagent preparation, microscopy (oil-immersion, stereo), electrophoresis, standard staining techniques.

Additional Skills:

- *Web & Product Skills*: UI/UX design (Figma, StreamLit), SEO, building content-driven websites, prototyping interactive web tools.
- *Media & Content*: Video editing (DaVinci Resolve), photo editing (Photoshop, Lightroom), audio editing (Ableton Live, Audacity), visual asset creation.
- $\text{\LaTeX}$ for scientific writing; clear communicator with experience explaining complex concepts to audiences in academic and pedagogical environments.

Extracurricular

- Volunteered for the safe rescue and release of over **100** snakes, coordinating with local residents and authorities to ensure safe capture, identification and relocation while building trust with the community.
- Volunteered at 'Soil and Soul', a social enterprise offering eco-friendly alternatives to chemical-based products; contributed to the design and development of two websites (including an e-commerce platform), improving discoverability and user experience.
- Interned at BioEnzyme Entrepreneur's Academy – a women-run non-profit promoting sustainable solutions and training 'Eco-Entrepreneurs'; helped build the organisation's website and produced multimedia content (articles, animated videos, banners) to support outreach and education.
- Raised funds to support mid-day meals for nearly **250** underprivileged children for one year (Akshaya Patra Mid-Day Meals Scheme), coordinating with peers and donors to maximise impact.